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Eric Jackson is the Founder and CEO of Element 47, a web design and marketing agency that helps businesses reach their marketing goals and connect to their next customer. Eric has been a member of EO for about 15 years. Before Element 47, he was the Founder and Managing Partner at Keystone Business Solutions and the President of the EO Nashville Chapter.

Here's a glimpse of what you'll learn:

• The qualities of a supportive EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) forum partner
• What does Gestalt/Forum Mindset mean?
• How to optimize forum experience-sharing
• Facilitating action on unresolved problems during deep dives
• Colton Mulligan talks about utilizing 5% reflections to extract meaning from experiences
• What is a clearing round, and why is it important?

In this episode…

Are you struggling to identify with your EO forum partners? Maybe you're unable to resonate with shared experiences or reflection questions. So, how can you support your partners in their forum deep dives while benefiting from the experience yourself?

Forum sherpa Colton Mulligan's suggestion: be selfish. Instead of dispensing general advice after a shared experience, it's helpful to complement your partner's concerns with a similar experience. This is known as the Gestalt Method, or more recently, Forum Mindset, which seeks to provide comprehensive value through unified experiences. Similarly, when facilitating questions during reflection periods, Colton emphasizes asking broad and universal questions about each story's implication, rather than specific questions that only apply to the individual.

In today's episode of The Decision, Robert Hartline is joined by Colton Mulligan of FoxFuel Creative and Eric Jackson of Element 47, to discuss how to be a supportive partner during EO forum deep dives. Together, they explain the Gestalt/Forum Mindset Method, how to optimize forum experience-sharing, and how to facilitate action on unresolved problems.

Resources mentioned in this episode:

• Robert Hartline on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/bobbyhartline/
• CallProof - https://callproof.com/
• EOS (Entrepreneurial Operating System) Worldwide - https://www.eosworldwide.com/
• EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) Nashville Chapter - https://eonashville.com/
• Colton Mulligan on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/coltonmulligan/
• FoxFuel Creative - https://foxfuelcreative.com/
• Eric Jackson on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/ericpauljackson/
• Element 47 - https://element47.co/

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Transcript

0:02 ·

Applause

welcome to the decision from Nashville EO where you will hear the rest of the story after tough decisions were made by entrepreneurs who faced adversity and live to tell about it

Music

0:23 · welcome to the decision that moment in time where you're stuck and you need a little bit of help this podcast is going to help teach you best practices on how to give an excellent Deep dive how to be coached and how to coach in this episode episode 3 we're going to talk about how to be a great formate in a

0:48 · presentation and with us today we have Eric Jackson 15 years in EO I am Robert Hartline eight years and then we have Colton Mulligan who is an expert like a a form Sherpa yeah or Shaman which one are you I mean that's just on the wizard on the Litany of things I am called you know what I mean yeah you name two of the twelves so yeah you're like this uh form uh Pro like you're almost certified I

1:18 · hear almost certified is exactly yeah is exactly the way to do it so I'm certified through form Sherpa with Ellie bird which means at this point over the last four years I've worked with hundreds of EO YPO Harvard Business School Forum members facilitating

Retreats about getting to the five percent um you know getting value out of your Forum Vision planning for yourselves and you know yada yada yada and then hopefully fingers crossed by the time this podcast airs hopefully or

1:45 · thereabouts I'll be officially EO certified through their uh facilitator training if they need a recommendation we will certainly write one when we Eric I'll consider yeah yeah we'll do that for sure on the professional side not personal you wouldn't stand up for me in a court of law no yeah now if you're if you're watching this episode um he said a lot of buzzwords just a moment ago and I want to make sure if you want to get those Buzz words cleared up see episode one episode two yeah

2:13 · there's a little bit uh of length in the podcast there's a lot to learn and I went in this experience with uh let's say an older set mindset of what it's like to be informed and uh the reason we brought Colton here is some of the words in language has changed and so when you're listening to this episode and you're going why is he saying Deep dive instead of a presentation well that's

2:38 · the new terminology that you're using right when he says a five percent reflection well that's the new terminology for talking about updates and those types of things in today's episode what we're talking about essentially is um being a great formate receiving a

2:58 · deep dive so you can help that coached Deep dive um you know flow so I can give some experience share that would benefit him so walk us through uh some basics of

3:13 · being a good formate what's just the basics here I already disagree with you great only because uh I think what you said is very fair you said uh how am I going to give an experience share that benefits them I love to flip it to help with what I'm sure we'll get into which is Gestalt and Forum mindset I tell people when you do your experience share be selfish you

3:39 · see what can you get out of your experience share by exploring the space because if I'm thinking about how am I going to benefit Robert with my experience share I start to create an element of Leverage I can benefit you versus thinking man I'm going to use this opportunity to explore how I the last time I had feelings just like Robert did the last time I was in this situation and that whole idea that EO talks about now which is the Journey of self-discovery and group Discovery is uh

4:11 · one of the cornerstones that they talk about it by way of a deep dive yeah and and when I started my Entre EO experience um I started using this word Gestalt that everyone was using this word to Gestalt and I've talked about Gestalt with other people outside of EO and I describe what Gestalt is and one day I just went on this little Google Journey to Find a definition of Gestalt and I was like uh

4:40 · what does this have to do with anything what we're talking about because the definition is an organized hole that is perceived as more than the sum of its parts that doesn't seem like anything that where to the hell did this term the skull come from me and Vern Vern harness the uh the father of EO have not had this discussion I need to though to ask him uh

but it's also you're citing the reason why they've done away with it and they now call it Forum mindset I don't know the actual reason I'll give you my take on it so real quick uh Gestalt was

5:12 · like a form of psychology and a philosophy that they went through that has almost nothing to do with Forum the term that they used I think is fair and it's interesting it's what I I do like Gestalt you know the the whole is greater than the sum of its parts the way I've historically explained it which I just made up is not uh I can't quote this anywhere else is um humans are really actually pretty smart and I'd like to think that most EO members are as well and when you spoon

5:41 · feed someone all of the little ingredients of the thing they will come away with a much better appreciation and understanding if you give them the whole tell them your whole experience rather than the direct pieces of advice because that whole is how we learn best we have to do a little of the work ourselves rather than just being spoon fed all the little ingredients so that's my take on it but EO calls it Forum mindset now so we don't have to worry about it and you know for me I was in a CEO Roundtable

6:12 · before I got into EO and the structure that form gave us with um you know how to run a great form experience in that level of process that exists was enlightening for me and helpful because I had experiences in my CEO Roundtable where a great haired dude that's been in business for 40 years when he says something right and outside of his actual experience

6:42 · he's giving advice that he is not journeyed through I've listened to some really bad advice that I took because we look at the gray hair and go this guy knows what he's talking about I better do what he says right and I've been burned and so it resonated with me understanding what Gestalt at the moment you know meant to me was like there's a lot of value in actually hearing real stories assigned to this experience is way

7:14 · better than listening to I should do this and that and that's why I love the idea of not putting the other person uh helping them in when I'm when I'm giving feedback it's like I'm gonna tell them what my experience was and I'm going to

7:32 · explain it in some detail and I'm not going to worry about solving that other person's problem they're going to get more out of that than if I'm trying to Riff on their issue if I'm just talking about what I experienced what what the situation was before there

7:48 · was a problem what the problem is what the outcome was and package that up and here you go you do what you want with it I catch myself outside of forum mindset and I had to write this into the agenda that I now try to say every time before we do I'm the moderator of our forum and

8:06 · uh I try at the right before we are about to do experience shares I try to always remind everybody listen for your own value I know I flipped out of forum mindset when as I'm listening to other experience shares I'm thinking about the presenter the the person that would have the topic I'm thinking how is this going to benefit them and the whole point is during this time be selfish I'm just

8:30 · listening to what you're saying and I'm not thinking about whether or not you're helping to solve somebody else's problem I am just thinking what am I learning from what you're sharing they're going to interpret the way they're going to interpret your feedback and they could they could get more they're going to get probably more from it if you're just if you are being selfish they're going to hear that story and not hear it it can sometimes be uh almost like a a a

8:57 · disguised advice or disguised attack on the person or you know if if you package it up right and it's all about you they're able to look at it from a third party as a third party and gain knowledge not what are they trying to tell me and I think it's amazing when you're going through that experience in your mind where you're taking yourself back to their it's an experience that you actually had and then you're trying to recount

9:27 · the feelings from the past and as you start telling the story it's so funny how you start unpacking and go oh I I learned this about how I react to these types of things but you don't you don't actually remember the lesson until you've had

9:45 · enough time and space between to go oh wow you know there's more to that experience than I thought right and it's like a lot of obstacles that we face in our business where you get hit with an obstacle and you're like oh my gosh oh the sky is falling and ultimately what you actually discover is that was a beautiful opportunity disguised as a major issue and by acknowledging that you had this

10:13 · experience that was so awful but if I had not gone down that path oh I would have never met or done this or experienced this next thing because it's really ultimately don't you think it's like the purpose of why we are there is to learn others lessons yeah it's why it's

10:32 · interesting you talked about uh so because I facilitate Retreats uh with at this point hundreds of members I've gotten to watch the way folks interact and I've gotten to see what you're talking about what I commonly refer to as uh in in our form refer to it as the ringer or the heavy which is the person

10:49 · that's like they're over 50 mil or they're at 100 Mil they've had their exit commonly they may have gray hair or whatever and when I'm facilitating Retreats sometimes I'll try and figure out who that is before just a fun game I play in my head who it is before we do intros and stuff but it's interesting that you guys were talking about that and I've seen the uh the Heavies fall on

11:08 · either side of it there there are those that will wind up doing uh experience shares and I'm modeling open coaching and we're doing a deep dive and I have actively heard people go oh man I'm gonna need more time I've got a lot of experience with this one I've got a lot of things to share on this one and I already know like we're going to have problems with for a mindset and and this guy or gal I uh I have a um in my

11:30 · remarkable two here plug uh go ahead and download that use coupon code uh I've got a I've got a tagged element that says takeaways and I've got that when somebody drops a real knowledge bomb I put it in there it is never the people that are trying to give advice they're saying man 20 years ago I had to start

11:48 · saying to myself what is the energy I'm bringing into this room or is it something like that I'm just throwing that out there and those individuals I love when I watch someone that has been in Neo and they've got for a mindset and they are truly sharing their own experience and reflecting on rather than just thinking about how am I going to help you the knowledge that falls out of those people man I can't can't get a bucket big enough hmm and you know so many times uh you're sitting in a in an experience share

12:18 · situation where you know we've all been there you're like okay what do I got in my bucket of mistakes what I got in my library of stupidity that I could bring to the table what if I got nothing in the library to share shut up have you ever seeded your time yeah probably not often enough because

12:41 · sometimes I start talking and telling you know giving feedback and go man this is really stupid I should have passed it I'm gonna regret this we feel like we should be talking why is that we have ego needs and identity I think it goes back to wanting to help that person it's like oh gosh I got to come up with something because I really feel for this person nothing sometimes right yeah help us just shutting up

13:08 · I I say um I mean sometimes I I'll I'll think after I've done my three-minute experience share and I I should have just said uh man that sucks me too the what's the the Mitch Hedberg joke where he says he's walking down the street and the guy goes the guy he said I was walking down the street with my friend and uh the guy said man this guy

13:29 · looks trippy and Mitch Hedberg says maybe it is not that the sky is trippy but instead it is the way that we perceive it that is indeed trippy and then I thought I should have just said yeah I'm like I think that every now and then I should have just said yeah it's kind of like saying hey how's it going yeah say okay yeah I don't want to hear the story that's fine except in Forum where I want to hear the story I want to hear the story do you want to hear the story yeah and and um and you know getting that form experience uh shared properly

14:03 · sometimes it's best through the pain story like having a real story behind it because we forget about um the emotions right but it's the emotions that get us to really get deeper into why we were really feeling and to bubble that emotion up so you can find out to the heart of um you know what were the what was the outcome like what was the real mistake that you made was the mistake that you went about the process wrong or was the mistake and this the decision right that

14:35 · you made can I lean into something you just said just a second ago um you were talking you both used the term relevance and resonance which I think is great EO is pushing that now as a thing to strive for strive for resonance rather than relevance relevance is a direct experience that I have where there are facts of a situation that align resonance especially around feelings is that concept resonates with me right like I'm sure it deals with sound and some you know Reverb or something fancy that I don't know I'm not an audio engineer you get it vibration yeah yes uh trust the

15:08 · guy uh yeah anyways guitar guitars resonate that's what makes the sound I trust a musician over myself when it comes to these things so uh here's what here's what I think is

great when it comes to Yes it it is great to seed your time if you don't feel like you have a resonant experience but I also think it's great at times when someone talks about you know I've been in rooms where somebody says I just found out that my brother just fell off the wagon after seven years and he's fallen hard and I'm

15:35 · trying to figure out how to intervene and that winds up being you know the element and uh sometimes people say you know what are the types of experience shares you're looking for well have you had a sibling a sibling that has gone through you know uh anxiety depression drug abuse Etc and you've tried to help them or a resonant thing is it's like

15:57 · you know to jump up a level that I think is still fair and you don't have to seize your time if the group is open to it when is a time when you have been more invested in somebody else's success than they were themselves and how have you dealt how have you dealt with that which is still Fair it may have nothing to do with drug abuse or anything like that but it has everything to do with the concept of boundaries which is really what you're talking about there the concept of boundaries and how invested am I in your

16:24 · success and emotionally what does that do does it strain our relationship when I want more for you than you want for yourself and what are the outcomes of that I think I would value something like that because at the end of the day we're still talking about the same emotions and feelings that resonate so let me let me change directions just for a minute because this is a challenge I've seen in multiple forms formate with the same problem

16:50 · every time they come to form how do we navigate this as a form to say oh my gosh enough decide now like when are you going to decide how many conversations do we need to have I mean am I a little emotional about this yes uh because uh you know ultimately at the end of the day um I know people are ready to make a decision when they're ready to make a decision I get it but at the same time

17:18 · um how much energy should we devote to someone who loves to talk but takes no action Eric you raised your hand on the repeated problem unresolved yeah I was that guy for a long time well you want to share what it was um I had uh this feeling that uh an experience that my business partner and I were not aligned and that

17:49 · it wasn't working so you know I tried to make it work for many years and you know we both we both had our problems right and where we uh we eventually decided to split and my my Forum was probably happier than I was that this was finally over that they wouldn't have to listen to me anymore talk about you know this this problem that I could have fixed ultimately it was uh my reticence to do

18:14 · it was two things number one I was just afraid of not having a business partner and number two I like being on a team and so I felt like I was giving something up having that experience I've been able to replicate that through having a leadership team and trusting people with a lot of uh responsibility you know that aren't an owner um so yeah it it's um I just I wasn't ready I wasn't ready to pull the Band-Aid off and take that next step and

18:45 · there was nothing anybody could do to make me now if you could go back because that was a reoccurring issue could something have happened in coaching or during that process of your

19:01 · Deep dive that you could have gotten there faster in this because did it is it is it that the Deep Dives didn't work because you kept bringing it bringing it and bringing it and just didn't work you think they could have done something different I think uh no I don't I don't think so I mean ultimately I just needed my partner to say I don't think this is working either so you did the decision with no decision which took a really long time you know a great prophet once said uh How does it

19:32 · go uh even if you don't make a choice you even if you choose not to decide you still have made a choice Neil Pierre wrote that I think Rush anyway yeah the musician again with jokes that we're not you know that is you know I I see this over and over and I ask myself are we doing

19:53 · what do you do in that situation because I I've heard this situation from the same individual three times they're not moving move move you know you just want to inspire them for action but but we're not talking that for me just looking back I think that a good question would have been what what is holding you back from choosing to do something different than what you're doing now or questions of that sort of just you

20:26 · know what's what's the feeling you wish someone had gone deeper yeah I don't have a best practice for this so uh when you say like what is the answer I know one thing that helps so when I do uh when I do facilitations and Retreats that deal with a vision goal setting uh you know life planning life design and they're going to share that with the group a really important question that I have everybody ask at the end is what uh

20:51 · what do you want from the group or on a scale of one to ten what level of accountability do you want a 10 is I'm going to do it in my five percent reflection and I want you to ask me and I want you to say hey Colton or get off the pop buddy that's a 10. a one is I don't even want you to ask me if I bring it up you can go thanks for sharing at best I am a one I don't like

21:13 · accountability don't you ask me about my I have got my own complicated relationship with with accountability right interesting so my group knows now granted I'm I'm being somewhat I'm not really being facetious but I'm speaking in hyperbole here in reality I want people to ask me about things but I think it is really really key that you understand the culture of your forum and what you've said is ground rules and if people are different I've heard it said hey guys we're a group of high performing professionals entrepreneurs what is this group if not a place to

21:44 · hold each other accountable for high performance I believe that is probably Michael burcham's Forum because I know the way that they roll with kpis and they're on it right I know others that say I've got accountability groups that's not what I have here I'm looking for relationship and I'm looking for empathy right here so yeah and you bring up something that's important to me is I want to be called doubt I don't want to but I need to be and I recognize that not maybe at the moment of you calling me out but in reflection uh it it

22:12 · definitely will shake me up when someone is like Robert this is the third time that you've talked about you've chosen chosen nothing like dude where are we going we the one of the benefits I think of having a a forum that you know has existed for 15 years is that we have had

22:34 · several of those experiences and we've actually nicknamed them so that we can break just bring up the nickname of that particular indecision to a person to communicate to everybody else hey you know you don't want it to be X I can't use the words on this podcast but it um don't be uh right

22:58 · okay is this is this your version of a certain name here yeah yeah yeah they go oh wow I hadn't thought about it that way yeah I'm gonna add you're not gonna believe this can you believe that you guys are offering me value you know what I mean I don't think that coming into this thing I'm literally going to add something to my parking lot I need to explore I was thinking about this my whole Forum knows Colton doesn't want accountability don't do that he'll give updates and stuff like that and you can ask him about it when you have a conversation and they'll say you know oh why haven't you done that yet I need to

23:26 · explore why I have a complicated relationship with accountability and why like I get elevated emotionally when I'm in that space and I realize nobody else in my forum is they fall on a spectrum and like folks like yourselves yeah man kick my ass ask me why I haven't moved I think it's fine for there to be a spectrum I need to explore why I'm so extreme on my end of it and that's I'm going to make it a parking lot I I'm an EOS implementer and they teach us call it's called you know entering the danger zone and and if you want

23:59 · an outcome of any sort uh that is anything meaningful you got to create a little bit of tension and uncomfortable conversations and and I'll be willing to bet Colton actually does pretty well with being called out

24:18 · I mean I I think at the end of the day would find it valuable in a week after maybe I called you out you may have been frustrated angry with me whatever for calling you out but I think in reflection you would be like well I'm better off to be clear it never gets me angry it's that I'm too dismissive which probably deals with ego and arrogance and all that stuff which is obviously issues that I can dive into but that's my issue very little pisses me off there's a lot that I can be dismissive of because I'm I I'm working on EQ every

24:48 · day um yeah so you know when it comes to uh the the the the form experience how do you deal with someone who's boring did I say the boring word yeah you did someone who's boring well it's it's uh

25:06 · they're not going to the five percent is that what you mean well they're not bringing enough to the table in terms of uh an actual solvable you know that they're not they're not coming with a deep dive that's that is it's almost like they just pulled it out of the trunk of their car and they have been driving around it for weeks but it's not meaningful especially when you know they've got bigger problems yes it's like like why are we even talking about this like an elephant in the room is this thing here let's talk about that

25:37 · but I know we're not supposed to do that but you see what I'm saying when you guys do your five percent Reflections at the end do you guys rank importance and Urgent that's something I I we have neglected to do in our form this really makes makes me reconsider the way we I think honestly as I've done this these now three episodes I'm looking at my form in a completely

26:00 · different light and and you know to be real I think um I think I've been needing more value out of my form experience in this this conversation has made me go oh gosh let's we got these things we need a retreat now um if you guys uh so if forums aren't doing impromptu presentations uh then the need for it isn't as strong but if you think about if it's a five percent reflection you got eight people in your forum and they're all gonna share three things then you got 24 topics right and

26:32 · okay how are you going to get down to it ours has an actual equation at the bottom of our form and it says on a scale of one to ten how important is your number one topic on a scale of one to ten how urgent is it important gets multiplied twice and then you add it and then it gives you a very simple well these are the scores at the end of the time granted and it's very difficult for folks that is not necessarily the be-all end-all but it gives you the default to go to after everybody's done with their five percent and you're determining your impromptu presentations it gives you a

27:02 · framework to start off with all right well Robert you were 27 about that issue with your dad are you comfortable are you in a space to do that or does that need to be a parking lot item for later and and what go ahead I want to say that my Forum voted on who should do an impromptu presentation in the past like we we would hear all the different all the different issues that were brought up in well not issues but uh uh

27:29 · Reflections and then we would we would you know make a list of the ones that seem to be the most most hot and then vote on those yeah and you know it's just just in hearing this conversation you know I use the wrong word because I said boring and in reflection what I'm really saying is I'm recognizing that they weren't giving us the five percent and what they presented was fake

27:55 · here's this thing I'm going to put a screen in here we're going to talk about this thing but everybody knows who's behind the curtain and not really having that so it kind of reminded me on um going deeper and really maybe that

28:11 · conversation happens in the parking lot when we're gonna talk about what what's the issue and being willing to go all right you've had this on the parking lot for you know you we keep bringing it and it's back on this parking lot like can we have a conversation why that's on the parking lot three times in the last five years we we actually have um a secretary Who records the things that we're talking about with each uh five percent reflection slash update and

28:43 · he'll go back and say well a year ago this happened two years ago this happened three years ago this happened and you can see patterns that's how it form stays together for 15 years that's right we're keeping it spicy I like it no that's awesome I mean I really do think

that's a best practice that most forums don't invest in the time and the role record keeping he's our permanent secretary I love that can can I uh add one little

29:08 · thing to the the ratings there that helps and it sounds like it might be similar to what you're doing um we find a lot of value in this um Alex Tolbert was our seed moderator and he modeled this for us and I loved it and so I stick it in very few forms I found do this but you do your five percent Reflections at the very end the Scribe goes back through and this can take way too much time if you don't make it truly just this but if this was a form of the three of us and I was the Scribe and we all did our stuff at the very end when we're all done I say okay uh let's see Robert your three things were that thing with your dad uh your

29:38 · business tax issue and retirement planning and then we'd go to your left and I'd say Eric of those three things what do you think would be good for Robert to present on and then you tell me what yours is I do it and then it goes back to you and it's not a voting system as much as you get to hear it here's what's interesting is that it gives everybody I call it like putting a little English on it so you might have said the dad issue right and he goes ah

30:02 · the dad issue and I may say very briefly I may say the dad issue you but specifically living up to expectations of others and then it gives you I can't tell you how valuable that is and sometimes even if I'm not the presenter my buddy Beau did this to me recently where I was talking about problems and stuff like that and he said he said not dealing with problems but he goes being

30:22 · the guy I was like what do you mean he goes you just you either put yourself in or find yourself in a lot of situations where people use this phrase throw it over the fence ah Colton will solve it uh you know do this and over our time together and form he spotted it and I was like holy cow either I've got a Superman complex or this or that and I don't even present that day immediately went on to my parking lot only because he had the opportunity to reflect and know me and just say hey I'd like to present and while everybody else said X problem he said being the guy and I was like this is deep that's that's when you got the

30:54 · right formates asking the right questions at the right time to help you get there um changing direction just a tad um clearing rounds talk about clearing rounds what what uh what's that all about man I love clearing rounds um can I talk about why it's important real quick all of that so here's what here's what here's why clearing rounds are necessary and what is a clearing around first off except a clearing round is a great way to open up a meeting I say put 10 minutes on the agenda for it

31:25 · I will be honest if people haven't been doing clearing rounds and I train clearing rounds at every retreat commonly I've been in times where the clearing round was supposed to take 10 minutes where I'd model it they do it it's taken 90 minutes we have lost and they're paying I'm 5 500 bucks for an eight-hour session and we burn 90 minutes or two hours of vision and life planning because there was some they had not dealt with yet unfortunately I think it's healthy it's a good use of time but if people had healthy clearing rounds they wouldn't do that clearing around is as we go into it

31:57 · the point of it is to say is there anything any tension any judgment anything from me where I've been offended or maybe I feel like there's something I should apologize for or

something you should apologize for that is stopping me from showing up as my full self and being able to perceive any of your experiences without judgment right now right and so what clearing rounds are practically is we would open up and if it was us I have to point at you and look you in the eye and say Robert I'm clear with you Eric I'm clear

32:25 · with you Kevin I'm clear with you Billy I'm clear with you Ashley I'm clear with you and then the thing I've added that is not necessarily in like EO A playbook I call it the self-clear one of the best tools where I think in relation in my relationship to the Forum itself is there anything I need to clear and that right there is one of the vehicles that lowers the conflict barrier because

32:50 · I'm probably going to say something right now and the group has a chance to respond to it where um like to give very practical examples there's times where I've said hey this isn't one individual but as moderator we've talked about having Forum mindset in Gestalt I did a bad job last time of

33:07 · of calling everybody out for that and I need to be better about it to be honest the other way I could have done that is you were breaking Gestalt and you were breaking Gestalt and you were and it gives others the chance to talk about that thing that otherwise would be tense because I don't know if you've been moderator and called people out on it I've had people Grump at me and roll

33:25 · their eyes when I say no no no no no use statements only I statements hey I need you to restate that right it helps lower that tension because otherwise that mounts you know what I mean so that's one example but man different political religious beliefs all the things that can happen in a forum now that can lower that can lower the transparency and vulnerability because all these defenses and judgment is going up it's exactly what clearing rounds are for and it's creating some level of conflict that

33:53 · gets people having maybe a heated conversation and that gives some trust that hey we know that people will say something difficult we want difficulty in the conversation sometimes Gallup strengthsfinder says that healthy

34:09 · conflict is intentional is one of the things that they found from researching like 80 000 workplaces and all that stuff um it's I don't know if it's a I was going to say it's enough of a problem but obviously EO is blowing up especially in the Nashville chapter so I don't know that it's fair to say it's a problem but it's at least an issue to address that coming so I was facilitating Retreats through covid and between you know 2018 through now 2022 the number of things uh things going on

34:38 · in the world whether it's social justice or religious political Etc the types of tension that were Rising got to be enough that I was brought in by a chapter to do a four hour boost with every single Forum in that chapter and the uh spouse and life partner forums

34:57 · just about special curriculum four hours on conflict communication and clearing and it had how to apologize like an adult it had everything from a bid system from which deals with marriage and interpersonal things how to judge the subtleties when someone's trying to do relationship repair all this stuff that's super helpful I'm going down a rabbit hole

but I obviously care about it this has been great Colton I want to say thank you for taking the time to spend with Eric and I to ReDiscover what it

35:26 · means to have a deep dive conversation how to be coached and most importantly how to receive a great Forum presentation to provide value for those of us in making the decision

35:43 · to the decision by Nashville EO we'll see you again next time and be sure to click subscribe to get future episodes

Music

foreign

Applause

Music

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